

has been doing boys' and men's cuts for decades, and he still charges rates from the 1970s. You'd be surprised at how all that experience can translate into a gift for keeping the little ones still. (And they get to sit in that "Big Boy" pedestal chair!)

4. Hit the beauty schools

You may not trust a beautician-in-training with your hair (although I've gotten nothing but fantastic results), but that doesn't mean your toddler can't take the risk. With prices at 25–50% off retail, you can get all the kids' hair done for the price of one salon cut! (And if there happens to be a "mishap," you can blame it on your child's imaginary friend.)

5. Cruise the retirement circuit

Someone's grandma used to be a hairdresser. The key is finding her. (Ask around.) Since zoning ordinances may prevent private individuals from conducting hair business from their home, it may not become a regular thing. For an emergency trim or for in-between cuts, that "has-been" stylist could really come in handy! Sometimes they will forgo payment entirely in lieu of a nice trade (the same goes for any private stylist—not just those who are retired).

Stay creative and remember that you only have a few short years where the kids won't care how their hair looks, and that means a smaller hair-care budget! — **Linsey Knerl**